Proposal: Moving the team wiki to plain Markdown

Summary

Our wiki currently lives in a hosted service that we pay for per seat. Most pages are edited by two or three people, and almost nobody uses the features that set it apart from a folder of text files. This proposal recommends moving the wiki into a Git repository as plain Markdown, reviewed through the same pull requests we use for code.

Motivation

The hosted wiki has three problems:

1. **Cost.** We pay for 40 seats, but only 12 people edited a page last quarter.
2. **Drift.** Pages describe how systems worked when they were written. Nothing ties a page to the code it describes, so nobody notices when it goes stale.
3. **Review.** Edits go live immediately. There is no way to propose a change and have someone else look at it first.

Keeping documentation next to the code addresses all three.

~~Keeping documentation next to the code solves all three~~. It is free, it changes in the same commits as the code, and every change is reviewed.

Plan

We will export every page to Markdown using the wiki's built-in exporter, commit the result to a new `docs/` directory, and fix broken links by hand. The migration should take about a week. After that, the hosted wiki becomes read-only for one month and is then shut down.

Risks

Non-engineers may find Git intimidating. We can mitigate this by allowing edits through the web interface of our Git host, which needs no local setup.

Search will be worse at first, since the hosted wiki has full-text search built in. A static site generator would give us search back, but that is out of scope for now.

Decision

We ask the team to approve the migration ~~by the end of the month~~ by 30 October 2026.

Comments not found in the text

Review comments on proposal.md, exported by annox: gaardhus.github.io/annox

“Some non-engineers will probably find Git intimidating at first.”

Sam Reviewer: Which teams? Support and design both edit the wiki every week, so it matters who we're p…

“Ops has agreed to keep a snapshot of the old export on S3.”

Claude: Who owns the snapshot after the shutdown, and how long is it kept?